As the `explanation` object's `description` says, *Lords* does not match the indexed data. Understanding the reasons for a match (or lack of a match) helps us troubleshoot the status of queries (for example, in the previous example, we know that the matching term doesn't exist in our index). If you retry the query in listing 8.21 using the `explain` flag, you may not get any information back from the engine other than an empty array.

A search query built using the `explain` flag on the `_search` API can produce many results. In my opinion, asking for an explanation of all document scores at a query level is a waste of computing resources. Instead, pick one document and ask for an explanation using the `_explain` API.

8.8.4 Sorting

By default, results returned by the engine are sorted on the relevancy score (`_score`): the higher the score, the higher on the result list. However, Elasticsearch lets us manage the sort order of the relevancy score (ascending or descending), and we can also sort on other fields, including multiple fields.

SORTING RESULTS

To sort results, we must provide a `sort` object at the same level as `query`. The `sort` object consists of an array of fields, where each field contains a few tweakable parameters:

```
GET movies/_search
{
  "query": {
    "match": {
      "genre": "crime"
    }
  },
  "sort": [
     { "rating" :{ "order": "desc" } }
  ]
}
```

Here, the results of a `match` query that searches for all the movies in the crime genre are sorted by movie rating. The `sort` object defines the field (`rating`) and the order in which the results are expected to be sorted—in this case, descending order.

SORTING ON RELEVANCY SCORES

Documents with relevancy scores are sorted on `_score` in descending order by default if no sorting is specified in the query. For example, the query in the following listing sorts the results in descending order because a sort order is not mentioned.

Listing 8.22 Default sorting of scores in descending order

```
GET movies/_search
{
  "size": 10,
  "query": {
    "match": {
```